

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

Paul pointed out that we shouldn't force anyone to give grudgingly, because it's a willing giver that God loves (2 Corinthians 9:7). Give what you believe God has asked you to give.

QUESTION 4. What about consumer credit counseling?

We have had financial difficulties for the first year of our marriage. A friend recommended that we use the consumer credit counseling service. Are you familiar with them?

ANSWER: Yes I am. In fact, I am on the board of advisors for CCC's in Atlanta, Georgia.

In general, their counseling service is excellent and has helped many couples. I have two hesitations about endorsing their service nationwide. Since each group is independent, they each establish their own guidelines. Some do not promote tithing while in debt and, in fact, will not allow it while dealing with a couple's finances. The second negative is that they actually take over the management of the finances while the debts are being repaid. Therefore, the couples don't learn to manage their own finances and will quite often get back into debt.

QUESTION 5. What about disability insurance?

Our insurance agent has recommended that I buy disability insurance. I don't know if this is really necessary at age 25. Do you have any directions?

ANSWER: Disability insurance is used to provide the income that is lost when someone is disabled and unable to perform his or her normal work for a year or more. It is relatively expensive insurance, depending on the monthly income guarantee and the duration that it will be paid. In other words, the higher the monthly payment and the longer it must be paid, the higher the cost.

A wage earner who pays into Social Security has some disability insurance. Social Security will pay a disabled worker approximately 60 percent of his or her yearly wage if that